

D'Matek Brand Identity Handoff

Brand Architecture & Business Context — detailed strategic handoff for Brand Identity work | V1

Document Status

Purpose: This is the strategic handoff document for the next stage of D'Matek Brand Identity work. It gives the identity work the business, architecture and brand context it must design around.

Source basis: D'Matek Brand Identity V2, D'Matek Brand Master — Source of Truth, D'Matek Brand Bible, plus the business architecture and division decisions established in the D'Matek project.

Important: Parent brand decisions already locked in the Brand Master remain locked. Business architecture may evolve as D'Matek matures.

1. What D'Matek Is

D'Matek Technology Limited is a problem-solving company powered by technology.

We make difficult things simpler and better.

Brand essence: **The company you trust to figure it out.**

External tagline: **SOLVING WHAT MATTERS.**

Internal mantra: **WE'LL FIGURE IT OUT.**

Technology is the means, not the identity. D'Matek can build technology, integrate technology, operate technology, manage technology and supply technology where those capabilities help solve a meaningful problem.

2. Why the Architecture Matters to the Brand

D'Matek is intentionally broader than any single technology category. The parent must therefore communicate capability, trust, problem-solving and human progress rather than becoming visually or verbally trapped in networking, cloud, cybersecurity, software or another single category.

The brand system must allow D'Matek to grow into new technologies, businesses, products and ventures without requiring the parent identity to be redesigned every time the company expands.

The architecture should make a complex multi-business company feel like one coherent company to customers.

3. Long-Term Ambition

D'Matek is being built with a long-term ambition to become known for solving important problems in Nigeria, then applying successful solutions across Africa and, where appropriate, globally.

The company should feel global in ambition while retaining Nigerian roots.

D'Matek is intended to evolve as opportunities emerge: capabilities can become services; services can become operating businesses; businesses can become brands or companies where justified; successful products can become ventures or independent companies.

The architecture is deliberately designed for evolution rather than assuming the final corporate structure exists today.

4. Locked Parent Brand Foundation

Positioning

- A problem-solving company powered by technology.

Essence

- The company you trust to figure it out.

Tagline

- SOLVING WHAT MATTERS.

Mantra

- WE'LL FIGURE IT OUT.

Purpose

- To make life and business work better by solving problems people can trust us to solve.

Vision

- To become a trusted company known for making difficult things simpler and better.

Mission

- We solve problems, build better solutions and stay with our customers every step of the way.

Values

- TRUST — We keep our word.
- SOLVE — No problem is too small.
- CONNECT — You don't take the journey alone.
- IMPROVE — We continuously find better ways to create value.

Promise

- You can trust us. You won't be alone. We'll figure it out.

Personality

- Capable; trustworthy; human; curious; confident; resourceful.

Service philosophy

- Leave people better than you found them.

Mistake philosophy

- Own it. Fix it. Learn from it.

Communication principle

- UNDERSTAND → SIMPLIFY → SOLVE → SUPPORT.

Customer journey

- DISCOVER → UNDERSTAND → SOLVE → DELIVER → SUPPORT → IMPROVE.

Core belief

- If there's a problem, there's a way.

5. Locked Visual DNA

Master identity

- Direction A master logo is locked.
- Meaning is built, not inherited.
- The logo is a vessel; the system, experience, consistency and time create meaning.

Visual territory

- Human Progress = technology with humanity.

- Core tension = PRECISION × WARMTH.

Typography

- Manrope.

Graphic language

- D'Matek Line: a continuous-line language representing Problem → Understand → Solve → Deliver → Support → Improve.

Core palette

- Forest Green #06382E
- Progress Green #28705A
- Gold #D4A637
- Warm Cream #F5F1E8
- Charcoal #1A1A1A
- White #FFFFFF.
- Green should dominate; gold is punctuation.

Photography

- People + Problems + Progress + Outcomes.
- Show what becomes possible because D'Matek solved something, not technology for technology's sake.

Voice

- Confidence + Clarity + Humanity.
- Clear, intelligent, helpful, direct, calm, human, confident and practical.
- Avoid jargon, empty hype and technology-for-technology's-sake language.

6. Fundamental Business Architecture

Current model: one legal company, six operating businesses/divisions.

D'Matek is externally one company and one customer relationship. Internally, the six divisions are specialist operating businesses with distinct territories, capabilities, processes and eventual commercial accountability.

Architecture

- D'Matek Technology Limited
- 01 D'Matek Infrastructure
- 02 D'Matek Cloud
- 03 D'Foundry
- 04 IléMesh
- 05 Matek Emporium / Matek Provision
- 06 D'Matek Assurance
- Group Functions
- Products / Ventures

7. The Six Businesses

01 — D'Matek Infrastructure

- Territory: Infrastructure & Connectivity.
- Role: design, build and operate connectivity and physical network infrastructure.
- Core idea: Connect it.
- Proposition: Infrastructure Doesn't Happen by Accident.
- Future direction: managed connectivity, internet services, ISP/telecommunications and potentially a larger D'Matek Networks business.

02 — D'Matek Cloud

- Territory: Cloud & Digital Infrastructure.
- Role: computing, hosting and digital infrastructure.
- Core idea: Run it.
- Scope: cloud, servers, hosting, storage, backup, DR and related digital infrastructure.
- Future direction: managed cloud and broader digital infrastructure/platform capability.

03 — D'Foundry

- Territory: Software, Digital Products & Integration.
- Role: turn business problems, ideas and opportunities into software, digital products and technology platforms.
- Core idea: Build it.
- Scope: custom software, applications, automation, integrations, SaaS and digital products.
- Future direction: reusable platforms, products and independent product ventures.

04 — IléMesh

- Territory: Smart & Connected Systems / Connected Environments.
- Role: connect physical spaces, devices and systems so environments become more intelligent, secure, automated and manageable.
- Core idea: Connect the physical world.
- Scope includes smart homes, smart buildings, IoT, CCTV, access control, hotel technology, building automation and connected facilities.

05 — Matek Emporium / Matek Provision

- Territory: Technology Commerce, Distribution & Procurement.
- Role: source, supply, distribute and make technology accessible.
- Core idea: Source it.
- Emporium represents a commercial destination/retail orientation; Provision represents B2B sourcing, procurement and supply. The naming choice remains open.

06 — D'Matek Assurance

- Territory: Advisory, Managed Services & Cybersecurity.
- Role: help organisations understand, manage, secure and continuously improve technology.
- Core idea: Manage, protect & improve it.
- Strong relationship to the D'Matek 'WE STAY' philosophy and the idea of D'Matek becoming an extension of a customer's IT department.

8. One-Customer / Multiple-Specialist-Business Model

D'Matek sells outcomes, not divisions.

The customer should not need to understand D'Matek's internal organisational chart before receiving a solution.

Customer brings a problem → D'Matek understands it → appropriate specialist businesses are assembled → D'Matek presents and coordinates the solution → delivery happens across the required teams → D'Matek stays involved.

Example: hotel technology project

- Infrastructure: network, Wi-Fi, connectivity and communications.
- Cloud: servers, hosting, storage and digital infrastructure.
- IléMesh: CCTV, access cards, elevator access, room power, smart locks, IPTV/TV control, DSTV/Pay-TV integration, building automation and connected-room technology.
- Foundry: custom hotel software, integrations or portals where required.
- Commerce: source and supply hardware/equipment.
- Assurance: managed IT, cybersecurity, monitoring and ongoing support.

9. Boundary Logic

Infrastructure vs Cloud

- Infrastructure owns the network/connectivity layer. Cloud owns compute, hosting, storage and digital infrastructure. A data-centre project can therefore involve both.

Foundry vs the other divisions

- Foundry creates software, applications, digital products and integrations. It does not automatically own the underlying network, cloud, physical systems or managed service relationship.

IléMesh vs Infrastructure

- IléMesh owns the connected physical environment and system integration. Infrastructure provides the network/connectivity layer that those systems may depend on.

Commerce vs delivery divisions

- Commerce sources and supplies equipment. It does not automatically own the technical architecture or service relationship.

Assurance vs specialist engineering

- Assurance can own managed service/customer operational responsibility while Infrastructure, Cloud, Foundry or IléMesh provide specialist engineering.

Industry verticals

- Hospitality, healthcare, education, fintech, transport, retail, real estate, government, manufacturing and similar sectors are markets/use cases, not automatically new divisions.

10. Products, Services, Businesses and Brands

Core distinction

- Capability ≠ Service ≠ Operating Business ≠ Brand ≠ Legal Entity.
- Product ≠ Division.
- Industry ≠ Division.
- Logo ≠ Company.

Business maturity

- Capability → Service → Operating Business → Independent Business → Company → Strategic / Spinout.

Product maturity

- Customer project → Reusable solution → Product → Product business → Venture → Independent company.

Brand rule

- Build businesses, not brands.
- Build brands only when the business needs a brand.
- Brand independence follows business maturity, not the other way around.

11. Brand Architecture Model

Branded House with Selective Identity.

Parent-branded businesses

- D'Matek Infrastructure
- D'Matek Cloud
- D'Matek Assurance

Distinctive endorsed businesses

- D'Foundry
- IléMesh
- Matek Emporium / Matek Provision

Distinctive identity is permitted where there is a genuine business reason, but each business remains visibly and strategically connected to D'Matek.

An independent-looking name or logo does not itself create a separate legal entity.

12. Existing Logo Library Context

The parent master logo remains Direction A and must not be reopened as part of division exploration.

Working candidate mapping established in the project

- D'Matek Cloud → existing candidate #2.
- D'Foundry → existing software family #3 / #8.
- D'Matek Infrastructure → existing candidate #4.
- D'Matek Assurance → existing #5 / #6 / #7 family.
- Commerce → #9 as a possible candidate.
- #10 → reserved/future asset; no current assignment.
- IléMesh → no logo assignment yet; do not invent one merely to fill the system.

These are working library assignments, not permission to redesign the parent logo or automatically finalise every division mark.

13. What the Brand Identity Work Must Solve

Create a parent system that can comfortably contain six very different technology businesses.

Allow division differentiation without producing six unrelated brands.

Make D'Matek feel global in ambition while retaining Nigerian roots.

Balance technical credibility with humanity and warmth.

Support enterprise, SME, consumer and institutional customers without becoming generic.

Make the brand extensible into future cloud, connectivity, software, smart environments, commerce, managed technology and ventures.

Ensure the visual system can express engineering, software creation, physical environments, commerce and trust without changing the parent DNA.

Keep the parent brand broader than Infrastructure.

14. Non-Negotiable Guardrails

Do not turn D'Matek into an infrastructure-only parent.

Do not reopen Direction A master logo.

Do not overuse gold or drift into eco/NGO/healthcare/security clichés.

Do not create a new sub-brand logo merely because a service exists.

Do not let division identities become six competing parent brands.

Do not use generic technology symbolism as the main identity language.

Do not let technical complexity destroy clarity or humanity.

Do not treat future businesses as if they are already separate legal companies.

15. Future Evolution

D'Matek may eventually become a group/holding-company structure as businesses demonstrate scale, market distinction, operational maturity and strategic value.

Potential future businesses include D'Matek Networks/connectivity, D'Matek Cloud or a broader digital infrastructure business, software/product companies, smart connected systems businesses, commerce/distribution businesses, assurance/managed technology businesses and independent ventures such as QADPAY.

The identity system should be designed so this evolution feels like a natural progression rather than a rebrand.

16. Handoff Summary

The identity team is not designing a logo for a single IT service company. It is building the identity system for a technology-powered problem-solving company that is intentionally becoming a multi-business technology ecosystem.

Problem first. Technology second. Impact always. is useful strategic territory for interpretation, while the locked outward brand expression remains **SOLVING WHAT MATTERS**.

The central design challenge is therefore: **How can one D'Matek feel coherent, capable and human while allowing very different technology businesses to grow underneath it?**